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Linguistic Tricks: A Semantic Inventory

Status: Working, source-backed inventory
Scope: Linguistic mechanisms discussed in the private source-development material; source filenames and links are withheld from this publication
Purpose: A component of the reality-anchored, truth-seeking epistemic constitution described in 0010-culture-mechanics.semantic and 0020-epistemic-agency.semantic-definition.md

1. Working concept

The reviewed source material uses *linguistic tricks* as a practical name for sophisticated forms of lying and truth-obscuring speech. The best analytical umbrella recovered during source development is **instrumental untruthfulness** (*instrumentelle Unwahrhaftigkeit*): communication governed primarily by the effect it is meant to produce rather than by truth, accuracy, sincerity, shared meaning, or reasonable resolution of disagreement.

This inventory therefore uses *lie* in a broad normative sense. An utterance need not contain a literally false sentence to belong here. It can mislead by omission, implication, presupposition, redefinition, framing, diversion, attribution, contextual manipulation, or corruption of the dialogue itself.

The family resemblance is:

A linguistic trick subordinates one or more truth-supporting conditions of communication to operative effectiveness while preserving enough of the appearance of communication to steer an audience.

This is not a claim that every use of rhetoric, framing, conceptual innovation, ambiguity, or a fallacious argument is intentionally deceptive. The classifications below concern their manipulative uses.

Sophism and sophistry

Sophism is an important established name for a large subset of what this inventory calls linguistic tricks. A sophism is an argument that appears rational or valid but owes its persuasive force to a concealed ambiguity, invalid inference, misrepresentation, irrelevant consideration, or comparable defect that obstructs truth-seeking. **Sophistry** is the practice or style of constructing and deploying such arguments.

The terms are related but not interchangeable:

- A **fallacy** is a defect in reasoning and can be committed accidentally.

- A **sophism** is an apparently plausible, argument-shaped maneuver whose defect is concealed or exploited; the term ordinarily carries a stronger implication of strategic or intellectually dishonest use.
- **Sophistry** is the systematic practice of producing, combining, or habitually relying on sophisms.
- A **linguistic trick** is broader. It also includes non-argumentative operations such as omission, euphemistic inversion, defamatory labeling, dog-whistle messaging, information flooding, and source manipulation.
- **Instrumental untruthfulness** is broader still: it is the governing orientation that subordinates truth-supporting conditions to operative effect and can employ sophistry alongside many other mechanisms.

The conceptual nesting is therefore:

```

instrumental untruthfulness
├── direct and informational deception
├── semantic and rhetorical manipulation
├── sophistry
│   └── sophisms
├── dialogue manipulation
└── propaganda and systemic deployment

```

Sophisms should consequently not be added below as one more mechanism beside equivocation, presupposition smuggling, straw men, burden reversal, or motte-and-bailey shifts. They are a **cross-cutting, argument-shaped class** instantiated by many of those mechanisms. A mechanism becomes sophistical when it is incorporated into an apparently reasoned case whose concealed defect supplies its persuasive advantage.

2. Integrity dimensions

The inventory normalizes the mechanisms against nine dimensions developed during the private source-review process.

Code	Integrity dimension	Governing question
TI	Truth integrity	Are asserted propositions presented in accordance with the speaker's evidence and beliefs?
II	Information integrity	Is relevant information included rather than selectively withheld or flooded out?
RI	Relevance integrity	Does the response address the actual issue and evidence?
CI	Clarity integrity	Is the communication sufficiently clear to permit scrutiny?
SI	Sincerity integrity	Does public speech truthfully express what the speaker thinks?
MI	Meaning integrity	Are words used in shared, stable, and inspectable senses?
DI	Discussion integrity	Are the standpoint, burdens, reasons, and closure rules handled fairly?
LI	Dialogue integrity	Is the overt kind of conversation also the operative kind of conversation?
XI	Context/source integrity	Are origin, context, identity, and evidential status represented honestly?

These dimensions are diagnostic, not mutually exclusive boxes. One mechanism commonly violates several at once.

3. Inventory

A. Assertion and information selection

LT-001 — Direct falsification

- **Aliases:** lie by commission; false assertion.
- **Operation:** Assert as true a proposition the speaker believes to be false or inadequately supported.
- **Integrity:** TI, SI.
- **Status:** Established core category.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-002 — Omission and selective concealment

- **Aliases:** lie by omission; suppression; selective disclosure.
- **Operation:** Present a technically compatible fragment while withholding information needed to form the materially correct picture.
- **Integrity:** II, TI, SI.
- **Status:** Established core category.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-003 — Paltering and false implicature

- **Aliases:** misleading truth; deceptive implicature.
- **Operation:** Use literally true statements to induce a conclusion the speaker regards as false, retaining the escape that the false conclusion was never explicitly stated.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, SI.
- **Diagnostic:** Ask what a reasonable listener was meant to infer, not only what the sentence literally entailed.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-004 — Bullshit and evidential indifference

- **Aliases:** assertion without truth orientation; argumentative bullshit.
- **Operation:** Speak for impression, status, mobilization, or persuasion without treating the truth or falsity of the content as a governing constraint.
- **Integrity:** TI, SI.
- **Status:** Established category; distinct from a lie narrowly defined because knowledge of the truth need not guide the speaker.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-005 — Trade-off suppression

- **Aliases:** one-sided effect selection; effect/side-effect asymmetry.
- **Operation:** Describe only the desired effect or only the unwanted side effect of a measure, thereby concealing that action and inaction both involve benefits, costs, risks, and alternatives.
- **Integrity:** II, RI.
- **Status:** Project-developed term; the exact formulation was not located in the reviewed source material during this pass.
- **Diagnostic:** Require the same ledger—benefits, harms, uncertainty, alternatives, and opportunity costs—for favored and disfavored measures.

LT-006 — Information flooding

- **Aliases:** firehose of falsehood; attention saturation; epistemic overload.
- **Operation:** Produce claims at a volume and speed that exceeds the audience's capacity to test them, allowing important disagreements to drown in low-cost messages.
- **Integrity:** II, RI, TI.
- **Status:** Established propaganda family; also a bridge from individual speech acts to systemic lying.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

B. Meaning, implication, and framing

LT-007 — Equivocation and private-definition escape

- **Aliases:** semantic ambiguity; mental reservation; strategic polysemy.
- **Operation:** Exploit a word's different senses—or silently use a specialist/private sense—so the audience receives one meaning while the speaker later retreats to another.
- **Integrity:** MI, CI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-008 — Persuasive redefinition

- **Aliases:** persuasive definition; semantic extension or contraction; illegitimate extension of vocabulary; definitional drift.
- **Operation:** Preserve a word's favorable or condemnatory emotional force while changing the cases to which it applies. The inherited evaluation is transferred without having to justify it anew.
- **Integrity:** MI, DI.
- **Examples of form:** "True freedom is obedience"; expanding a grave term so that minor or disputed cases inherit its moral force.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-009 — Doublespeak and euphemistic inversion

- **Aliases:** Newspeak; semantic cosmetics; inverted meaning; bureaucratic euphemism.
- **Operation:** Rename an act so that its description obscures agency, cost, coercion, or moral character—or makes an adverse reality sound benign.
- **Integrity:** MI, CI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-010 — Presupposition smuggling

- **Aliases:** presupposition manipulation; loaded question; assumption smuggling.
- **Operation:** Encode a disputed proposition as already given rather than assert it openly, so accepting the grammatical frame silently concedes the point.
- **Integrity:** TI, MI, DI.
- **Diagnostic:** Extract every proposition that must already be true for the question or sentence to work.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-011 — Selective framing

- **Aliases:** frame control; aspect selection; interpretive steering.
- **Operation:** Select and emphasize aspects of reality so as to privilege a problem definition, causal account, moral evaluation, or remedy while rendering competing descriptions less visible.
- **Integrity:** II, RI; sometimes MI.
- **Boundary:** Framing is unavoidable; the trick lies in concealing consequential selections, excluding rival frames, or presenting a contestable frame as reality itself.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-012 — Outcome relabeling

- **Aliases:** terminus relabeling; "true X" maneuver; procedural-value substitution.
- **Operation:** Stretch a procedural or contestable value into an absolute, declare existing practices counterfeit, then reserve the value's name for the speaker's preferred outcome—for example, defining democracy as the policy that "the people truly want."
- **Integrity:** MI, DI, LI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-013 — Benevolent-language camouflage

- **Aliases:** care-speak; safety camouflage; coercion-as-care; convenience rhetoric.
- **Operation:** Describe expanding control, penalties, dependence, or loss of exit in the language of care, concern, safety, support, and convenience, thereby borrowing benevolent intent as a shield against structural examination.
- **Integrity:** MI, II, LI.
- **Boundary:** Benevolent language is not evidence of concealed coercion. The diagnostic is whether contestability, reversibility, and exit disappear behind it.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-014 — Dog-whistle double address

- **Aliases:** coded appeal; dual-audience messaging.
- **Operation:** Use an expression with an innocuous public reading and a second, group-coded reading, enabling mobilization of insiders alongside deniability to outsiders.
- **Integrity:** MI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-015 — Diffamatory fighting term

- **Original term:** *diffamierender Kampfbegriff*.
- **Operation:** Attach a negatively charged label to a person, group, or idea so moral rejection occurs before factual examination; justification is replaced by moral marking.
- **Integrity:** RI, MI, DI.
- **Status:** User-selected compound term.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-016 — Symbol displacement

- **Original term:** *Symbolverschiebung*.
- **Operation:** Turn a neutral or minor object into the emotionally charged proxy for a diffuse conflict; shared rejection of the proxy synchronizes a group and substitutes symbolic hostility for examination of the underlying issue.
- **Integrity:** RI, II; sometimes MI.
- **Boundary:** This can emerge collectively without a designing speaker; it is therefore also a culture mechanism, not only a deliberate trick.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

C. Diversion and corruption of discussion

LT-017 — Quibbling and irrelevant precision

- **Aliases:** hairsplitting; trivial objection; pedantic derailment.
- **Operation:** Focus scrutiny on a minor ambiguity, exception, or wording defect that does not materially affect the disputed claim, creating the appearance of refutation while avoiding its substance.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-018 — Redirection

- **Aliases:** red herring; whataboutism; topic diversion; evasion.
- **Operation:** Replace the proposition under examination with another subject, comparison, accusation, or question that is easier or more advantageous to discuss.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI.
- **Diagnostic:** Restate the original proposition and ask whether the response changes its evidential status.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-019 — Psychologizing Bulverism

- **Original term:** *psychologisierender Bulverismus*.
- **Operation:** Evade examination of a thesis by presupposing it false and explaining instead which motive, pathology, identity, or defect allegedly caused the speaker to believe it.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI, TI.
- **Related but distinct:** ad hominem, genetic fallacy, motive fallacy, presupposition smuggling.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-020 — Standpoint substitution

- **Aliases:** straw man; misrepresentation; attributed-position drift.
- **Operation:** Replace an opponent's actual position with a weaker, more extreme, or more morally objectionable one and refute the substitute.
- **Integrity:** DI, TI, RI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-021 — Caricature-demonic phantom-enemy distortion

- **Original term:** *karikaturdämonisches Phantomfeind-Zerrbild als Hassfigur*.
- **Operation:** Construct a grossly exaggerated, morally demonized opponent from selected and invented attributes, then make this phantom a collective hate object. It is a socially elaborated straw man whose function includes affective mobilization and group identity.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI, DI.
- **Status:** User-developed compound term.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-022 — Burden reversal and immunization

- **Aliases:** burden shifting; unfalsifiable retreat; proof-demand asymmetry.
- **Operation:** Demand that critics disprove an unsupported claim, or continually alter what would count as counterevidence, insulating the favored position from the obligations imposed on alternatives.
- **Integrity:** DI, TI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-023 — Closure sabotage

- **Aliases:** moving the goalposts; false declaration of victory; refusal to concede.
- **Operation:** Change success criteria after evidence arrives, refuse the consequences of a defeated claim, or declare resolution without answering the decisive objection.
- **Integrity:** DI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-024 — Covert dialogue-type switch

- **Original umbrella:** *Dialogintegritätsverletzung*.
- **Operation:** Ostensibly participate in inquiry or critical discussion while covertly operating by the rules of another dialogue—personal quarrel, negotiation, propaganda, interrogation, or audience performance.
- **Integrity:** LI, DI, SI.
- **Example:** A request to examine evidence becomes an occasion to diagnose the questioner or signal loyalty to spectators.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-025 — Reversive blockade

- **Original term:** *Reversive Blockade*.
- **Operation:** Assert an extreme opposite of the truth so emphatically that an audience disposed toward moderation searches for a midpoint and lands at a conclusion still displaced from reality in the manipulator's preferred direction.
- **Integrity:** TI, DI, MI.

- **Status:** Project-developed term; the exact phrase was not located in the reviewed source material during this pass.
- **Related mechanisms:** anchoring, false balance, midpoint fallacy, strategic polarization.

LT-026 — Person/group substitution by neologism

- **Prompting example:** *Zufallsmehrheiten*.
- **Operation:** Introduce a novel label that redirects attention from the substantive issue to the character or composition of persons and groups, allowing the original subject to remain unexamined.
- **Integrity:** RI, MI.
- **Status:** Provisional project reconstruction; the exact term was not located in the reviewed source material during this pass. More source context is needed before treating it as a settled independent type.

D. Moral attribution and enemy construction

Working heuristic — The iron law of ideological projection The **iron law of ideological projection** is the working heuristic that the less a closed ideological formation can acknowledge and correct its own discrediting motives, practices, and intentions, the more strongly it tends to attribute them to its opponents.

This is a proposed culture-mechanical principle, not an established scientific law. It generalizes the source-attested partisan expression “The Iron Law of Woke Projection” into a structurally neutral term. “Iron law” denotes a recurrent tendency, not an exceptionless rule.

It must not be converted into the claim that every accusation is a confession. That would itself become a sophism: the origin of an accusation would replace examination of its evidence. Every accusation must still be evaluated on its own evidence.

The heuristic contains several increasingly specific phenomena:

- **Psychological projection:** attributing one’s characteristics, affects, impulses, or responsibilities to another; it can be unconscious and nonstrategic.
- **Negative total projection:** transferring a generalized inventory of disowned badness to the enemy.
- **Accusation in a Mirror:** attributing one’s particular act or intention to the prospective victim.
- **Moral inversion:** more broadly reversing aggressor/defender, responsible party/victim, or good/evil roles.
- **DARVO:** the reactive sequence of denial, attack, and victim–offender reversal.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-027 — Accusation in a Mirror

- **Aliases:** AiM; mirror politics; mirror accusation; *Spiegelbeschuldigung*.
- **Functional description:** preventive blame reversal; *präventive Schuldumkehr*.
- **Operation:** Attribute one’s own intended or ongoing aggression to the opponent so that one’s aggression can be interpreted in advance as defensive necessity.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI.
- **Functions:** Preemptive attribution, moral disinhibition, information fog, reaction delay, pretext formation, and plausible deniability.
- **Specialized neighboring term:** *Human-rights inversion* is used for related inversions in international human-rights discourse.
- **Distinction:** AiM is narrower than psychological projection and moral inversion. It specifically mirrors the actor’s own conduct or intention and is commonly pre-emptive.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-028 — Positive moral appropriation

- **Aliases:** moral transfer; co-option; glittering generality; strategic mimicry.
- **Operation:** Appropriate the respected symbols, achievements, virtues, or vocabulary of another tradition or group without accepting the practices that earned their positive standing.
- **Integrity:** XI, MI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-029 — Strategic moral reattribution

- **Original term:** *moralische Attributionsverschiebung*.
- **Operation:** Transfer one's own negative characteristics to the opponent while transferring the opponent's or a respected third party's positive characteristics to oneself. The combined operation performs a rhetorical "moral balance-sheet cleanup."
- **Negative subtype: Negative total projection** (*negative Totalprojektion*) attributes a broad inventory of the actor's or in-group's disowned vices to the enemy. Unlike strict AiM, it need not mirror one particular act or intention.
- **Positive subtype:** Positive moral appropriation transfers another party's virtues, achievements, symbols, or benevolent intentions to the in-group.
- **Integrity:** TI, XI, SI.
- **Status:** Synthetic family joining LT-027 and LT-028.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-030 — Comparison destruction and moral leveling

- **Original term:** *moralische Nivellierung*.
- **Aliases:** false equivalence; universalized cynicism; epistemic fog.
- **Operation:** When favorable comparison is no longer credible, make distinctions between better and worse appear unknowable or irrelevant: "everyone lies," "all sides are equally corrupt."
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI.
- **Effect:** Moral fatigue suppresses discriminating judgment without rehabilitating the discredited actor on the facts.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-031 — Protection blackmail

- **Original term:** *Schutz-Erpressung*.
- **Operation:** Admit or normalize one's own harms while claiming that only submission to the harmful actor prevents an even worse enemy: "we may be harsh, but we are all that protects you."
- **Integrity:** II, RI, SI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-032 — Reality-free escalation of invective

- **Original coined label:** *political Tourette syndrome*.
- **Operation:** Emit a continuous stream of increasingly grave accusations and taboo-laden insults with little evidential constraint, gaining affective force from the extremity of the vocabulary itself.
- **Integrity:** TI, RI, MI.
- **Naming caution:** The original label is metaphorical, not clinical, and risks stigmatizing a neurological condition. The descriptive heading above is preferred for the inventory.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-033 — Script-forming threat preactivation

- **Original term:** *skriptbildende Voraktivierung*.
- **Operation:** Repeatedly narrate the opponent as an imminent aggressor so a later ambiguous event is automatically recognized through the prepared script: their act is attack; ours is defense.
- **Integrity:** TI, II, RI.
- **Status:** Primarily a downstream cognitive and social effect of repeated AiM, but retained because it explains why the linguistic operation matters over time.
- **Terminological boundary:** *Script* here means a preactivated interpretive sequence for classifying a later event. It is narrower than the **situated-cultural-script** construct, which joins a general cultural weave to distributed roles, routines, interfaces, improvisation, and practical support.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-038 — DARVO

- **Expansion:** Deny, Attack, and Reverse Victim and Offender.

- **German description:** denial, counterattack, and *Täter-Opfer-Umkehr*.
- **Operation:** When confronted with alleged wrongdoing, deny the conduct, attack the accuser or their credibility, and recast the accused party as the real victim and the confronting party as the offender.
- **Integrity:** TI, RI, DI, LI.
- **Distinction from AiM:** AiM is commonly pre-emptive and prepares aggression as defense. DARVO is commonly reactive and protects an actor from accountability after confrontation.
- **Relation to moral inversion:** The final DARVO stage is a form of moral inversion or *Täter-Opfer-Umkehr*, but DARVO names the complete three-stage sequence.
- **Status:** Established term.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-039 — Moralized character accusation

- **Source term:** Michael Andrick's account of *Moralisierung* in *Im Moralegefängnis: Spaltung verstehen und überwinden*.
- **Operation:** Move the focus from the disputed issue to the other person's character and the dialogue mode from inquiry to accusation. Reinterpret a statement, omission, association, missing conformity signal, imposed marker, or attributed target label as a revealing disclosure of character, then use that accusation to attack the person's standing or eligibility to participate.
- **Integrity:** RI, DI, LI.
- **Status:** Borrowed from Andrick and operationalized for this inventory; the culture-mechanical field extension is project-developed.
- **Related but distinct:** psychologizing Bulverism, redirection, covert dialogue-type switch, defamatory moral marking, and legitimate evidence-based judgment of conduct.
- **Systemic extension:** The complete signal-character accusation-exclusion-enforcement mechanism and Andrick's category of discursive violence are developed in *Culture Mechanics*; they are not reduced here to a linguistic trick.

LT-040 — Cue-function substitution (*Wie-Was manipulation*)

- **Source term:** Dushan Wegner's *Wie-Was-Manipulation* in *Relevante Strukturen* (2019).
- **Aliases:** recognition-cue substitution; cue-function mismatch; moral camouflage.
- **Operation:** Supply the learned perceptible cues by which an audience recognizes a valued category while the underlying operation, structure, or consequences that make the category applicable are absent, materially weaker, or opposed. The *Wie* is the recognition route; the *Was* is what the category is meant to identify.
- **Integrity:** MI, II, RI; sometimes SI.
- **Examples of the general form:** visible moral vocabulary without the corresponding conduct; credentials or institutional form without the claimed function; symbolic compliance that substitutes for the result the symbol is supposed to indicate; camouflage or decoys that elicit a learned recognition response.
- **Diagnostic:** Specify the claimed category and its constitutive function, list the cues that activated recognition, inspect actual operation and consequences, and observe what happens when cue and function are compared openly.
- **Boundary:** Every practical category relies on fallible cues and proxies. Cue-function mismatch can arise through error, changed conditions, Goodhart-like drift, or an obsolete classification rule. Manipulation is a stronger inference requiring evidence such as strategic production of the cue, recurrent asymmetry, concealment of function, or resistance to consequence-based correction.
- **Status:** Wegner's distinction is retained in his language and operationalized here as a cross-domain diagnostic. It overlaps benevolent-language camouflage, ideological symbols, paramorality, and qualified-concept inversion without being reducible to any one of them.

LT-041 — Doctrinal causal omission

- **Aliases:** semantic-wrapper / operational-payload concealment; undisclosed implementation; CPU-bigOther split address.
- **Operation:** Present an attractive explicit doctrine to reflective cognition while withholding a material affective, social, or institutional mechanism on which the doctrine's constructor or operator relies to produce its foreseeable practical effect. The hearer is invited to assent to the semantic wrapper without being given the bigOther-facing or institutional payload needed to evaluate the actual programme.
- **Integrity:** II, SI, MI, LI; sometimes TI.

- **Diagnostic:** State the public principles, reconstruct the expected recipient classifications and emotions, identify the implementing offices, sanctions, dependencies, and authority relations, then compare those layers with plans, training, audience segmentation, private predictions, and observed descendants. Ask whether disclosure would predictably change reasonable assent.
- **Responsibility gradient:** intentional concealed construction → knowing omission → reckless omission → negligent blindness → unforeseeable emergence.
- **Boundary:** No finite doctrine can state every causal consequence, and social effects often emerge without a designer. A wrapper–payload mismatch establishes a question, not a lie. The stronger verdict **doctrinal lying by omission** requires evidence of knowledge or sufficiently culpable foreseeability, materiality, non-disclosure, and reliance on the omitted mechanism.
- **Related but distinct:** LT-002 concerns selective concealment generally; LT-013 camouflages control in benevolent language; LT-014 sends coded meanings to different audiences; LT-040 substitutes recognition cues for function. LT-041 specifically conceals the causal implementation that joins a public doctrine to its expected cultural and institutional outcome.
- **Primary semantic home:** *Mythology Construction*, “Doctrinal progeny, generative spirit, and responsibility”.
- **Status:** Project-developed communicative operation extracted from the doctrinal-progeny and concealed-causal-design analysis.

E. Agenda, representation, and policy coupling

LT-034 — Pretext trap of the harmful fix

- **Original term:** *Vorwandfalle der Schadtlösung*.
- **Operation:** Use a real problem as the pretext for a preselected measure presented as its solution even though the measure foreseeably preserves or worsens that problem.
- **Component operations:** Problem surfing, a causal story serving as a pretextual bridge, argumentative coupling, and concealment of the harmful or placebo character of the remedy.
- **Integrity:** II, RI, TI, LI.
- **Status:** User-selected term.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-035 — Ventriloquism of constituencies

- **Aliases:** self-appointed representation; constructed-interest speech; speaking for “the people.”
- **Operation:** Construct a group’s interests and speak authoritatively in its name without authorization, internal plurality, or a route by which members can contradict the attributed voice.
- **Integrity:** XI, SI, DI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-036 — Motte-and-bailey amplitude shift

- **Aliases:** mobilizing maximalism / scrutinized minimalism.
- **Operation:** Use a sweeping structural claim when mobilizing support, then retreat under criticism to a narrow technical claim; after scrutiny passes, return to the expansive implication.
- **Integrity:** TI, MI, DI.
- **Diagnostic:** Require one stable statement of the claim, its scope, and its proposed consequences across audiences.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

LT-037 — Context and source manipulation

- **Aliases:** false context; imposter content; manipulated content; information laundering.
- **Operation:** Preserve or fabricate content while falsifying who produced it, where it appeared, when it applied, or what evidential standing it has. Apparent provenance substitutes for argument.
- **Integrity:** XI, TI.
- **Project provenance:** Source details withheld from this publication.

4. Important boundaries

Honest error is not insincerity

A person can sincerely state a false belief, and can insincerely repeat a proposition that happens to be true. Sincerity and reality-tracking are distinct dimensions. The first constitutional step is to make it safe and normal for people to say what they actually think; only then can open disagreement test how well those beliefs track reality.

Semantic disagreement is not necessarily manipulation

Some disputes are genuinely verbal: participants attach different meanings to the same word. Clarifying definitions can dissolve confusion without establishing deceit. A reviewed private source supplies the relevant boundary case: shared definition repair is the remedy, whereas covertly changing a definition while retaining its emotional force is LT-008.

At society scale, persistent divergence can contribute to **intergroup semantic decoupling** and eventually **cultural interoperability breakdown (Babelization)** even when no speaker is manipulating anyone. That is a systemic condition, not a linguistic trick. Shared definition repair, trusted translation, and legitimate common procedures can increase the effective thickness or span of lifted solidarity without requiring identical first-order meanings. [Mythology Construction, “Cultural interoperability and its breakdown \(Babelization\)”](#) defines that larger condition and its anti-Babel floor.

Framing and conceptual engineering are not inherently dishonest

All finite descriptions select aspects of reality, and communities sometimes need better concepts. Manipulation begins when consequential selection or revision is hidden, rival descriptions are excluded from consideration, or the revised concept is represented as the word's uncontested natural meaning.

A recognition cue is not automatically a counterfeit

Language, credentials, symbols, institutional forms, and behavioural markers are often indispensable evidence of an otherwise difficult-to-observe function. LT-040 does not license the inference that every proxy is fraudulent. Its target is the inspectable mismatch between cue and function and, when manipulation is alleged, the further evidence that the mismatch was strategically produced, concealed, or immunized against correction.

An omitted mechanism is not automatically a lie

Complex doctrines cannot enumerate every psychological, institutional, and historical condition of implementation. LT-041 requires a material gap between the offered reason for assent and an operational mechanism on which the constructor relies. Intentional or knowing concealment, private causal prediction, audience engineering, repeated adverse offspring, and refusal to disclose after the mechanism becomes visible strengthen the diagnosis. Mere hindsight does not.

A fallacy is not automatically a lie

Bad reasoning can arise from haste, ignorance, motivated cognition, or honest confusion. A fallacy therefore becomes a sophism only when its plausibility is used to conceal or exploit the defect in the argument. This inventory classifies communicative operations, not the speaker's inaccessible inner intent. Evidence of a pattern, asymmetrical application, strategic retreat, resistance to correction, or concealed dialogue purpose strengthens an inference of sophisticated or otherwise instrumental use.

Effects are not always tricks

Symbol displacement, pluralistic ignorance, moral fatigue, and script preactivation can emerge through distributed repetition without a central designer. They belong here where they explain how repeated speech acts become a culture mechanism, but they should not be mistaken for proof of an individual plot.

5. Relation to the epistemic constitution

This inventory is not primarily a blacklist of forbidden expressions. In a reality-anchored, truth-seeking epistemic constitution it supplies a common vocabulary—a yardstick installed in the social *big Other*—for noticing when communication departs from truth-seeking.

The entries identify local operations; *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, “Audience-modelled reconstruction and decompression” supplies a cross-cutting model of how several such operations can be combined against an anticipated recipient so that the recipient reconstructs a targeted factual, causal, moral, or authorization model.

The corresponding positive virtues are:

1. State what one actually believes and distinguish belief from knowledge.
2. Check simple factual claims before amplifying them.
3. Present material counterevidence, trade-offs, and uncertainty.
4. Keep meanings explicit, shared, and corrigible.
5. Represent an opponent’s actual strongest position.
6. Answer the proposition before discussing the speaker.
7. Apply comparable evidential burdens to allies and opponents.
8. Keep the kind and rules of the dialogue visible.
9. Preserve provenance and context.
10. Permit correction without making honest concession socially ruinous.
11. Test identity-bearing and moral recognition cues against actual function and consequences.
12. Compare CPU-facing principles with the affective and institutional mechanisms expected to implement them.

The inventory’s function is thus constitutional and formative: it helps individuals recognize and resist small acts of public untruthfulness, while their repeated resistance changes the public norm that subsequently forms other individuals.

6. Provenance and limitations

This version was produced through structured review of private project source material, vocabulary expansion, contextual reading, synonym normalization, and boundary auditing. Source filenames, links, conversation identifiers, and internal prompt logs are intentionally withheld from this publication.

LT-039, LT-040, and LT-041 are explicit exceptions to that private discovery route. LT-039 was added from Michael Andrick’s book material and linked directly to the underlying publication. LT-040 was added from Dushan Wegner’s *Relevante Strukturen* (2019, ISBN 978-3-7394-0563-6), whose *Wie-Was* distinction is retained while the operational test and boundary are project-developed. LT-041 was developed in this project from the doctrinal-progeny analysis. Its originating contribution supplied the CPU-facing and bigOther-facing contrast; the inventory supplies the normalized operation, responsibility gradient, and evidential boundary.

This is a high-recall working inventory, not a claim of semantic exhaustiveness. The reviewed source collection is large, the same mechanism may have been discussed without any of the recovered names, and several private sources contain long embedded source texts. Future revisions should add newly found mechanisms only after checking whether they are genuinely distinct operations or aliases, combinations, effects, and institutional deployments of types already recorded here.

The labels *Reversive Blockade* and *Zufallsmehrheiten* were developed during the private source-review process but were not found verbatim in the reviewed materials during this pass. They are deliberately retained with provisional provenance rather than silently attributed to a source document.